DAY ONE — READ THIS FIRST

CHEM&121: Introduction to Chemistry

Dr. Karl Bailey (Dr. B) · Fall 2026 · September 21 – December 10, 2026 · Canvas Inbox only

If you read one part of this syllabus, read this one.

Item	Details
What it costs	**Chemfolio** *($19.50)* + **CHEM&121 Lab Manual** *($16.70)* (Clark Bookstore) + ALEKS (paid through your course registration).
When things are due	Wednesday through Sunday each carry something — see Weekly Flow below for the exact rhythm. Once you learn it, it repeats every module.
Time to budget	About 10–12 hours a week outside of lab, plus your 4-hour on-campus lab — see How to Work in This Class.
How to reach me	Canvas Inbox only — I don't use email during the term. I reply within 24 hours on weekdays.
The two big ones	Weekly lab attendance (required every week — see About the Lab Requirement for how a missed lab is handled) and the Final TYC (Teach Your Community) Project — 10% of your grade, in place of a final exam.
The AI rule	No AI-generated content in anything you submit — ever, no exceptions. See the AI Agreement below for the full policy.
If you fall behind	No explanation needed. Late work loses 1% per hour after the due date, down to zero after about 5 days — then it can still be submitted for zero credit. See Late Work below for the full policy.

Your grade in one line: 3-2-1 Team Posts 15% · OOL Discussions 15% · Lab Experiments 25% · Quizzes 20% · ALEKS Problem Sets 15% · Final TYC Project 10%.

Weekly Flow

TL;DR: Something is due nearly every day, Wednesday through Sunday — same pattern every week once you learn it.

Canvas Modules are your home base. This rhythm repeats every module — once you know this table, you know the whole term.

Day	What's due
Monday	New module opens
Wednesday (second lab day)	Team huddle in lab; OOL discussion post due
Thursday	3-2-1 Team post due, covering both Activities
Friday	TEAM LEAD POST due (Team Lead only, that week); OOL replies due; Lab Results (20 pts), Findings (10 pts), and Conclusions (20 pts) due
Sunday	3-2-1 replies to two teammates' ONE questions + both Activity PDF uploads due; ALEKS homework due; Lab Background (10 pts) and Methods (40 pts) due

Attend lab both days assigned in your schedule.

Quizzes are the one exception to this weekly pattern — they're in-person during lab, in Weeks 2, 5, 7, 9, and 10.

> **Dr. B's Note:** *Prioritize content learning in your Chemfolio with your team first. Labs are based on the assigned content from the module.*

How to Work in This Class

TL;DR: Same Activities as the in-person sections, on your schedule. Try each Activity on your own first, then use the Video Key to check and correct your work. Plan on 10–12 hours a week outside of lab. If it's taking more, or you're putting in that time and your quiz scores are low, check in with me.

Same course, your schedule. In-person sections spend 3 hours a week in class working these same Chemfolio Activities together, then finish and review outside class with the Video Keys. You do the same work. The only difference is that you choose when, and how fast.

How to work an Activity

1. Read the assigned Smith section.
2. Work the Activity in your Chemfolio on your own. Don't start the video yet.
3. Mark where you got stuck. That's your THREE.
4. Watch the Video Key to check and correct your work, and note in your Chemfolio what changed.
5. Bring what's still unclear to your team's huddle. That's your ONE.

Why this order matters. Points come from completing the work, but quizzes measure what you learned, and quizzes don't come with a video. If you can only do a problem while the video is playing, you haven't learned it yet. Getting stuck first and then fixing it is what makes it stick.

How much time. Plan on 10–12 hours a week outside of lab. Check in with me if either of these happens:

- You're regularly spending more than 12 hours a week.
- You're putting in 10–12 hours and doing all the work, but your quiz scores are low.

Either one means something about how you're working needs adjusting, and that's what Help Hours are for.

> **Dr. B's Note:** *Work smarter, not harder. Slow is smooth, and smooth is fast. Put your effort where it pays off most directly in learning: 3-2-1 Team Posts (15%), ALEKS Problem Sets (15%), and Quizzes (20%) together make up 50% of your grade — see How Will I Be Graded below. Lab work and OOL matter too, and both take real writing and analysis. Both will feel slow at first, and you'll get faster as we go. That's the point: both are professional expectations in your future career, which is why they're in this class.*

This is the condensed version, generated automatically from the same source as the full syllabus — so it can never drift out of sync. The full syllabus (with grading detail, the AI agreement, lab requirements, and all college policies) is linked from the top of the living syllabus page. If anything here and the full syllabus disagree, the full syllabus online is correct.